

The Knights Templar

No. 141

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

April 2026

The Knights Templar came to England in 1128. They first settled near Chancery Lane before moving to Fleet Street in 1184, where they built the Temple Church, now part of the Inner and Middle Temple.

Founded in 1109, the Knights Templar were a military religious order that protected pilgrims travelling to Jerusalem. Members took vows of poverty, chastity and obedience. The Order became wealthy through its land and banking.

After the fall of Jerusalem and Acre, the Templars' purpose came to an end. In the early 1300s, King Philip IV of France had many Templars arrested, and the Pope dissolved the Order.

The Templars left a lasting mark on England. The Temple Church is one of their finest surviving buildings.

This page has two images. The first shows the tomb of William Marshal, Earl of Pembroke, who died in 1219. The second shows the Knights Templar badge, with two knights riding one horse, symbolising their vow of poverty.



Tombs in Temple Church, London. William Marshal, 1st Earl of Pembroke, is in the far right glass case, with his son, the 2nd earl, on the far left



the badge of the Knights Templar, showing two Knights on one horse to emphasise their poverty